# Experiment 12

# Creating Reports and Dashboards for Data Visualization in Zoho Creator

## 1. Aim

To create reports and a dashboard in Zoho Creator that turn application records into useful operational information.

## 2. Objectives

- Understand how reports present records collected through forms.
- Create a report using appropriate columns, filters, sorting, or grouping.
- Design a dashboard with relevant charts or summary indicators.
- Interpret the displayed information and check it against source records.

## 3. Requirements

A Zoho Creator application containing sample data and access to its report and page-building features.

## 4. Theory

Reports organize stored records so users can search, filter, sort, group, and review information. Dashboards combine selected indicators and visualizations to provide a quick overview. A chart should match the question: bar charts compare categories, line charts show change over time, and summary values show totals or counts. Poorly chosen chart types, inconsistent data, or unclear labels can mislead users. Access permissions should prevent unauthorized users from viewing restricted records or aggregated information.

## 5. Procedure

1. Prepare a set of fictional records with meaningful categories, dates, and statuses.
2. Open the report area for the form and choose the fields to display.
3. Configure sorting, filters, or grouping to answer a practical question.
4. Create a page or dashboard and add suitable chart or summary components where available.
5. Use clear titles, labels, and date ranges.
6. Compare the report totals with the underlying records to verify accuracy.
7. Test the view with the intended user permissions.

## 6. Case Study and Analysis

A laboratory coordinator receives equipment requests and needs to understand workload, pending items, and frequently requested equipment. A report displays each request with its date, category, quantity, and status. Filters allow the coordinator to view pending requests or requests from a selected period. A dashboard then presents a count of open requests, a chart comparing requests by category, and a status breakdown. The coordinator notices that one category has a growing number of pending requests and can investigate whether the cause is supply shortages or delayed approval. The dashboard does not automatically explain the cause; it highlights where further investigation is useful. To avoid incorrect conclusions, the team checks whether records have missing categories and confirms that the selected date range is consistent. It also ensures that students cannot access confidential administrative fields. This case shows how reports support detailed review while dashboards provide a quick operational summary.

## 7. Result / Discussion

The report and dashboard organize request data into a detailed list and a high-level view of workload and status.

## 8. Conclusion

Useful dashboards start with a clear decision or question. Correct data, appropriate chart selection, clear labels, and suitable permissions are essential for trustworthy visualization.

## 9. Precautions / Best Practices

- Use fictional or non-sensitive test data during practice.
- Verify settings and results before using the application or configuration in a real environment.
- Record observations clearly and follow the platform's current documentation, security, and access-control guidance.